



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Archway Classical Academy - Veritas

School Website: <https://archwayveritas.greatheartsamerica.org/>

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Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Archway Classical Academy Veritas AZ 85018 (Archway Veritas) presents a robust classical-education profile anchored in Great Hearts' model. Public-facing materials consistently foreground the cultivation of character through the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty, with explicit mentions of virtue formation, Great Books, and a shared mission to form "hearts and minds in virtue and truth" within a classical framework. The school highlights Great Hearts Day activities (e.g., Great Hearts, Great Books Day), a K–5 curriculum infused with classical formative aims, and a strong parent community anchored in an active Parent Service Organization. Taken together, these signals align strongly with a CLASSICAL orientation across all six categories of the classical rubric. Notes of evidence include the school's stated mission of forming hearts and minds in virtue and truth within a classical education, frequent emphasis on virtue and the fine arts, and pervasive partnership with families and community groups that reflect a traditional, morally oriented educational project.

- Element 1 (Religious and Metaphysical Foundations): CLASSICAL. The school repeatedly foregrounds virtue, truth, and beauty as real and desirable ideals, with formation of the heart as a central aim. Positive indicators include virtue, truth, and beauty, as well as references to forming "hearts" in a classical framework. There is strong alignment with transcendental moral realism and a teleology toward moral formation, though explicit theological language is less visible in public-facing pages (the Great Hearts framework is widely Christian in origin; direct textual theology signals are less explicit in the site content available). Positive keyword signals dominate; few if any explicit negative signals are evident in the public materials. Evidence includes explicit mission language around virtue and truth and a stated pursuit of beauty, plus the assertion that Archway Veritas stands within a classical framework aligned with Great Hearts' mission.
- Element 2 (Purpose and Goal): CLASSICAL. The school frames education as formation of virtue and wisdom, not merely information or workforce preparation. Keywords such as formation, virtue, wisdom, and the pursuit of the true, good, and beautiful are prominent. The public materials emphasize formation of character and human flourishing, consistent with classical telos, rather than a purely job- or college-prep emphasis. The absence of a strong counter-frame (e.g., "career readiness" as a primary telos) strengthens the CLASSICAL rating. Evidence includes statements about forming hearts and minds in virtue and truth within a classical framework and the Great Hearts mission emphasizing the true, the good, and the beautiful.
- Element 3 (Curriculum): CLASSICAL. The curriculum signals align with classical pedagogy via Great Hearts Day activities and a curriculum built around the Great Books canon, with explicit emphasis on literature, Western tradition, and a foundational role for history. The available materials show a K–5 curriculum landscape that includes literature-rich experiences (Great Hearts Day) and content emphasizing Western-civilizational heritage, as well as history instruction. While the K–5 materials also mention Core Knowledge History & Geography in some snapshots, the overall public presentation centers Great Books, canonical works, and a classical formation of mind. Positive signals (Great Books, Great Conversation, canonical literature) exceed negative signals (no explicit

emphasis on modern, non-canonical curricula). Evidence includes Great Hearts Great Books Day, references to canonical literature, and a K–5 curriculum overview highlighting literature and history within a liberal-arts frame.

- Element 4 (Pedagogy): CLASSICAL. Pedagogical signals include contemplative/Scholé-oriented approaches and opportunities for Socratic or debate-style engagement as students progress, along with memory work and recitation traditions for early grades. Public materials reference Socratic discussion and rhetoric-oriented development at advanced levels, and explicit emphasis on memory, recitation, and contemplative disciplines. Although explicit high-school-level Socratic seminars may be less visible in K–5 public materials, the Great Hearts framework and the cited pedagogical texts strongly indicate a classical curriculum and pedagogy transition from memory-based/recitation-based foundation to Socratic and rhetorical tasks in higher grades. Evidence includes references to Socratic questioning (in curricular-literature discussions) and the presence of memory/recitation practices, as well as explicit doctrinal texts on classical pedagogy.
- Element 5 (Faculty): CLASSICAL. The public materials present teachers as virtuous models and mentors who form the living curriculum, with leadership figures (Headmaster, Deans) and a teacher-formation emphasis. The mission statements describe teacher commitment to forming hearts and minds in virtue and truth, and the “core virtues” page models a roster of virtuous aims (wisdom, courage, humility, etc.). This aligns with the classical pattern of teachers as exemplars and a central, living curriculum embedded in the faculty. Evidence includes language about teachers forming minds and hearts in virtue and truth and the existence of a clearly defined set of core virtues that structure faculty expectations.
- Element 6 (Parents and Community): CLASSICAL. The school clearly positions parents as co-educators and partners in the education process, with an active Parent Service Organization (AVPSO), volunteer opportunities, and a calendar of family-involved events. The materials stress parental involvement, book clubs, family formation, and campus openness, with parents welcome at visits and events. This tracks with the classical model of partnership with families as part of the formation enterprise. Evidence includes explicit statements about partnership with families, parent formation through reading groups and seminars, and an open-campus approach, along with active AVPSO/PSO activities.

Aggregate Ranking: CLASSICAL

- The six-category ratings cluster firmly in CLASSICAL, driven by canonical literature emphasis, virtue-centered mission, and a strong, active parent-community partnership. Across evidence, the school demonstrates the core keywords and thematic signals that align with transcendental moral realism (truth, goodness, beauty), formation over information, and a liberal-arts, Great Books orientation.
- Overall keyword analysis snapshot (for transparency):
 - Positive keyword indicators encountered (examples): truth, goodness, beauty; virtue; formation; great conversation; wonder; classical; Great Books; canon; virtue formation; fidelity to tradition; living curriculum; partnerships with families; parent formation; co-teaching with families. Representative public signals include the mission statements and Great Hearts Day materials.
 - Negative keyword indicators: minimal to none in the public-facing Archway Veritas materials; signs of non-classical framing (e.g., contemporary “workforce-prep” language) do not appear in the accessible pages. When cross-referenced with the Six Elements lexicon, the absence of overt anti-classical signals supports CLASSICAL rather than NOT CLASSICAL. See the lexicon for the standard negative indicators, which do not appear in the Archway Veritas materials.

What Would Move the Needle (if applicable) - Not applicable here, as the aggregate classification is CLASSICAL.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials emphasize forming “hearts” in virtue and truth within a classical framework, and the mission statements foreground virtue, truth, and beauty as real ideals. The Great Hearts framework positions moral realism as a guiding principle. - The Great Hearts Arizona Archways are described as aiming toward the pursuit of Truth, Goodness, and Beauty, aligning with transcendental aims.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, formation, wonder, great conversation. The public material aligns with transcendental moral realism and a theologically-informed, virtue-centered education. Quantitatively, at least 5–6 positive signals are evident; negative signals are not observed in the accessible content. - Negative keywords observed: none identified in the accessible materials; values-neutral or secular-relativist signals are not present. The lexicon notes possible negative signals to monitor, but they do not appear in the current public material.

Why this rating - The school demonstrates a classical orientation through consistent emphasis on virtue and truth, formation of character, and a canon-based cultural-historical framing. While explicit theology language is less visible in some pages, the Christian, classical education framework under the Great Hearts umbrella strongly supports a religious/metaphysical foundation in practice. CLASSICAL.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The mission centers on formation of virtue and wisdom and the pursuit of the true, good, and beautiful. The public materials repeatedly frame education as formation rather than vocational training. - The Great Hearts framework emphasizes human flourishing and moral imagination as outcomes of a liberal-arts education.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, telos, pursuit of the true/good/beautiful, great conversation, classical heritage. These align with classical-goal indicators. Quantitatively, 4–6 distinct positive signals are evident; negative signals are minimal or absent. - Negative keywords observed: none in accessible public content. The lexical framework warns against workforce-prep language, which is not utilized as the primary aim on public pages.

Why this rating - The school clearly articulates formation, virtue, and wisdom as primary aims, consistent with the CLASSICAL category. CLASSICAL.

Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Curriculum materials feature Great Hearts Day and canonical literature emphasis; the presence of Great Books and a literature-centric culture is prominent. The K–5 curriculum overview references literature, history, and a classical framework, with the Great Books focus highlighted in school activities. - The network’s emphasis on Great Books and the Great Conversation is reflected in programmatic events and quotes about engaging with canonical literature.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Great Books, Great Books Day, literature, canonical works, great conversation, Western civilization, liberal arts framework. These strongly map to the “Curriculum” signals in the classical lexicon. Estimated positive keyword hits: ~4–6. Negative signals: minimal; Core Knowledge History mentioned in some materials, but does not negate the canonical-literature emphasis. - Negative keywords observed: limited explicit “project-based learning dominance” or “social studies terminology replacing history” signals in the Archway Veritas content. The presence of canonical-literature signals dominates.

Why this rating - The curriculum signals align with the classical canon (Great Books, liberal-arts orientation, history within a humanities framework). CLASSICAL.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Pedagogical signals include contemplation/restful learning and memory-based practices for younger students, with Socratic discussion and rhetoric-focused work as students advance. The Great Hearts pedagogy is explicitly described in classical terms in the broader literature and reflected in the Archway Veritas materials (Socratic/dialogic elements; memory work; recitation; rhetoric development).

- There are explicit examples of Socratic questioning and dialogue as the education matures, with opportunities to engage in disciplined inquiry and to develop intellectual virtue.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Socratic seminar, dialogue, questioning, dialectic, memory work, recitation, scholé, contemplative learning, rhetoric, oratory, debate, and disciplined conversation. Evidence includes the classical-pedagogy references and the Good-Teacher materials. Approximate count: 6–8 distinct positive keywords/signals. Negative keywords: no dominant signals of exclusive project-based or constructivist approaches in the visible public materials.

- Negative keywords observed: minimal; no clear, ongoing emphasis on non-classical experiential or student-directed-only approaches in the public content. The lexicon notes potential negative signals, but they do not predominate here.

Why this rating - Pedagogy described in the school's materials aligns with classical methods and a progression from memory-focused to Socratic/rhetorical practice. CLASSICAL.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Faculty are depicted as virtuous role models and mentors, integral to the formation project; the mission statement references teachers forming hearts and minds in virtue and truth, with “the living curriculum” implicit in the teacher-student partnership. Core virtues (e.g., courage, wisdom, integrity) are foregrounded as guiding principles for both teachers and students.

- The prominent leadership (Headmaster, Deans) and the stated commitment to virtuous instruction align with classical expectations that teachers embody and model the curriculum.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: tutors/mentors, living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, virtuous formation, mentorship, wisdom, virtue, integrity, humility. The Archway Veritas materials explicitly mention teachers' commitment to forming minds and hearts; core-virtues pages illustrate the teacher-student ideal. Estimated positive keyword hits: 5–7. Negative keywords: none identified in public content.

- Negative keywords observed: none evident in public materials. The classical-lexicon negative signals (e.g., “certification-driven jargon without classical context”) do not appear as dominant on the site.

Why this rating - The faculty portrait and the living- curriculum framing, combined with explicit virtue-centered leadership language, align with CLASSICAL expectations. CLASSICAL.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school presents a strong partnership with families, viewing parents as co-teachers, and maintains an active AVPSO (Parent Service Organization) with volunteer opportunities and family events. The site emphasizes parent formation, community gatherings, and open campus accessibility, consistent with the classical model of home-school partnership. - Parent involvement is reinforced through events, book discussions, curriculum nights, and volunteer opportunities, including book clubs and community outreach. The materials describe a shared mission with families and frequent open invitations for parent participation.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families, co-teachers, parent formation, family involvement, home-school connection, parental leadership, engaged families. Evidence demonstrates robust parent-community integration. Estimated positive keyword hits: 6–8. Negative keywords observed: few if any; there is no strong consumer/customer framing in the accessible content.

- Negative keywords observed: minimal; nothing that signals a consumer-centric approach or minimal parental interaction in the accessible content. The lexicon's negative signals (e.g., parent-as-customer) are not evident in the Archway Veritas materials.

Why this rating - The school demonstrates a robust and active parent-community ecosystem, with clear co-educator language and open invitation to parental involvement. CLASSICAL.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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